

CREATING VERBAL COMPONENTS

If you'd like to say a spell's Verbal component, you may make up the words. However you make them, the goal is to create something that's easy to say and that doesn't mean anything in the real world. Consider this method: take the name of the spell, keep only one instance of each of its letters, and rearrange the remaining letters into words. For example, remove the second *l* from *Fireball* and rearrange the remaining letters to create *Ber Fila* or *Fel Bira*.

Somatic (S)

A Somatic component is a forceful gesticulation or an intricate set of gestures. A spellcaster must use at least one of their hands to perform these movements.

Material (M)

A Material component is a particular material used in a spell's casting, as specified in parentheses in the Components entry. These materials aren't consumed by the spell unless the spell's description states otherwise. The spellcaster must have a hand free to access them, but it can be the same hand used to perform Somatic components, if any.

If a spell doesn't consume its materials and doesn't specify a cost for them, a spellcaster can use a *Component Pouch* (see chapter 6) instead of providing the materials specified in the spell, or the spellcaster can substitute a *Spellcasting Focus* if the caster has a feature that allows that substitution. To use a *Component Pouch*, you must have a hand free to reach into it, and to use a *Spellcasting Focus*, you must hold it unless its description says otherwise (see chapter 6 for descriptions).

Duration

A spell's duration is the length of time the spell persists after it is cast. A duration typically takes one of the following forms:

Concentration. A duration that requires Concentration follows the *Concentration* rules (see the rules glossary).

Instantaneous. An instantaneous duration means the spell's magic appears only for a moment and then disappears.

Time Span. A duration that provides a time span specifies how long the spell lasts in rounds, minutes, hours, or the like. For example, a Duration entry might say "1 minute," meaning the spell ends after 1 minute has passed. While a time-span spell that you cast is ongoing, you can dismiss it (no action required) if you don't have the *Incapacitated* condition.

Effects

The effects of a spell are detailed after its duration entry. Those details present exactly what the spell does, which ignores mundane physical laws; any outcomes beyond those effects are under the DM's purview. Whatever the effects, they typically deal with targets, saving throws, attack rolls, or all three, each of which is detailed below.

Targets

A typical spell requires the caster to pick one or more targets to be affected by the spell's magic. A spell's description says whether the spell targets creatures, objects, or something else.

A Clear Path to the Target. To target something with a spell, a caster must have a clear path to it, so it can't be behind *Total Cover*.

Targeting Yourself. If a spell targets a creature of your choice, you can choose yourself unless the creature must be *Hostile* or specifically a creature other than you.